

# ARE WE THERE YET?

The masters of science-fiction once envisioned their future – Our present. Did we do it justice?

Prakrit Dhondiyal

IMAGING: ANIL T

Curiosity is a trait mankind has been instilled with since the dawn of time. A gift that we've squandered shamelessly, with undeniable results. It's this trait that makes us so inherently attuned to science and the kind of advancement it brings. Even those who don't admit it have, at least once in their life questioned their place in the universe. It's this question that drives people to push the boundaries of reality into the boundless depths of the human imagination. Subconsciously, we may all agree with the logic behind the platonic reality we live in. Despite this, nothing stops us from trying to prove that even the most out-of-the-box ideas our brains can come up with can be replicated on some level or the other.

Science-Fiction, similarly, has always questioned the impossible and tried to make it feasible, if not completely possible. Looking back into the history of science-fiction, it's enthralling how much of it has given people a goal to strive for. Taking

what can be characterized as Theoretical Physics and 'Fringe Physics' and bringing into our plane of reality is a true testament to man's unyielding nature.

Taking a real trip to the past, here is how far we've come to creating things that may have seemed far-fetched to even the person who thought them into existence:

## Advent of the Hovercar

Remember Doc Brown – scientist extraordinaire with a penchant for the insane.

But insanity is underrated. Question: What did he and Luke Skywalker have in common?

Answer: A Hovercar.

Sure, Luke had a futuristic 93-B Landspeeder and Doc had a modded DeLorean, but both gadgets had one fundamental thing in mind - an idea.

Michael Mercier and Chris Jones decided to put a hovercar together. They unveiled their prototype for the Mercier-Jones Hovercraft on the Charlotte Motor



The Mercier-Jones Hovercar